

# The Global Burden of Mental Illness: Prevalence, Impact, and the

A data-driven overview of global mental health conditions, disease burden, and treatment access (Global data, 2023)

# Hundreds of Millions Affected: 1 in 3 Women and 1 in 5 Men Face

**1 in 3**

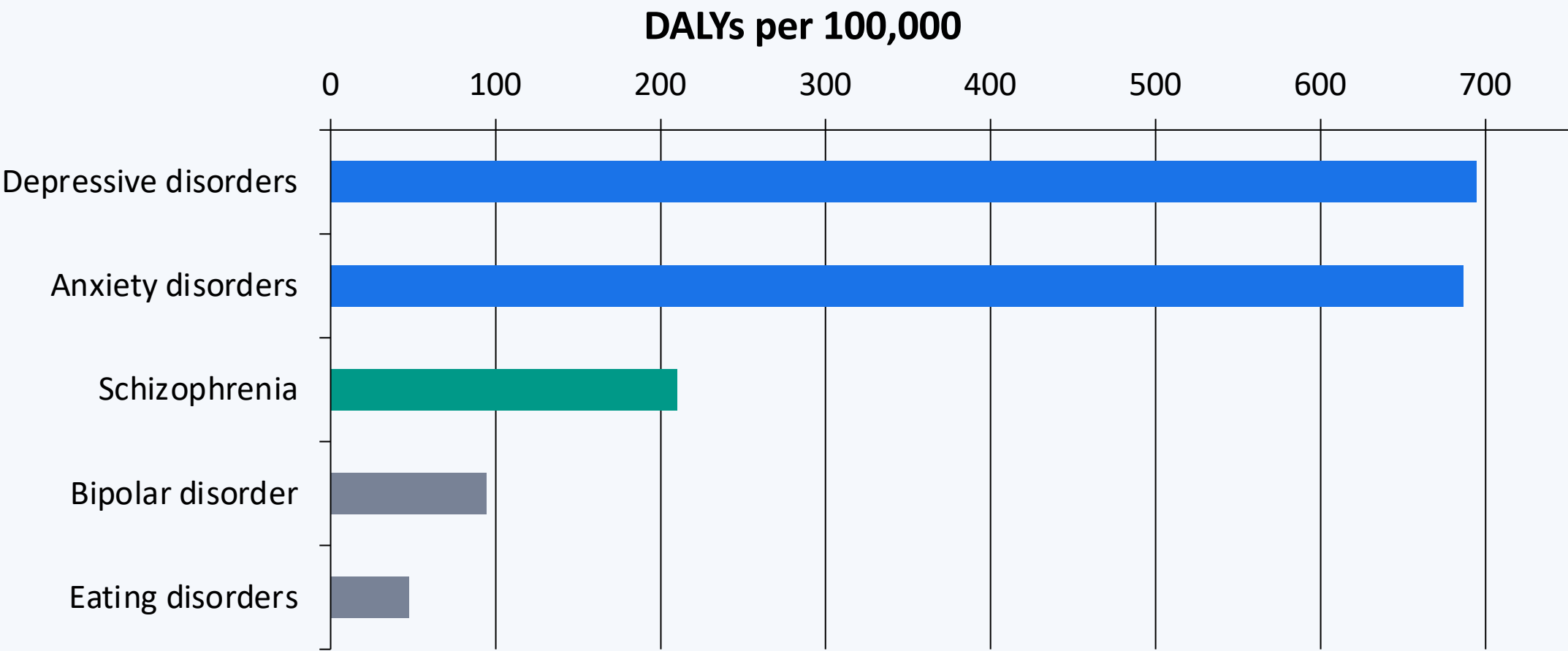
women will experience major depression

**1 in 5**

men will experience major depression

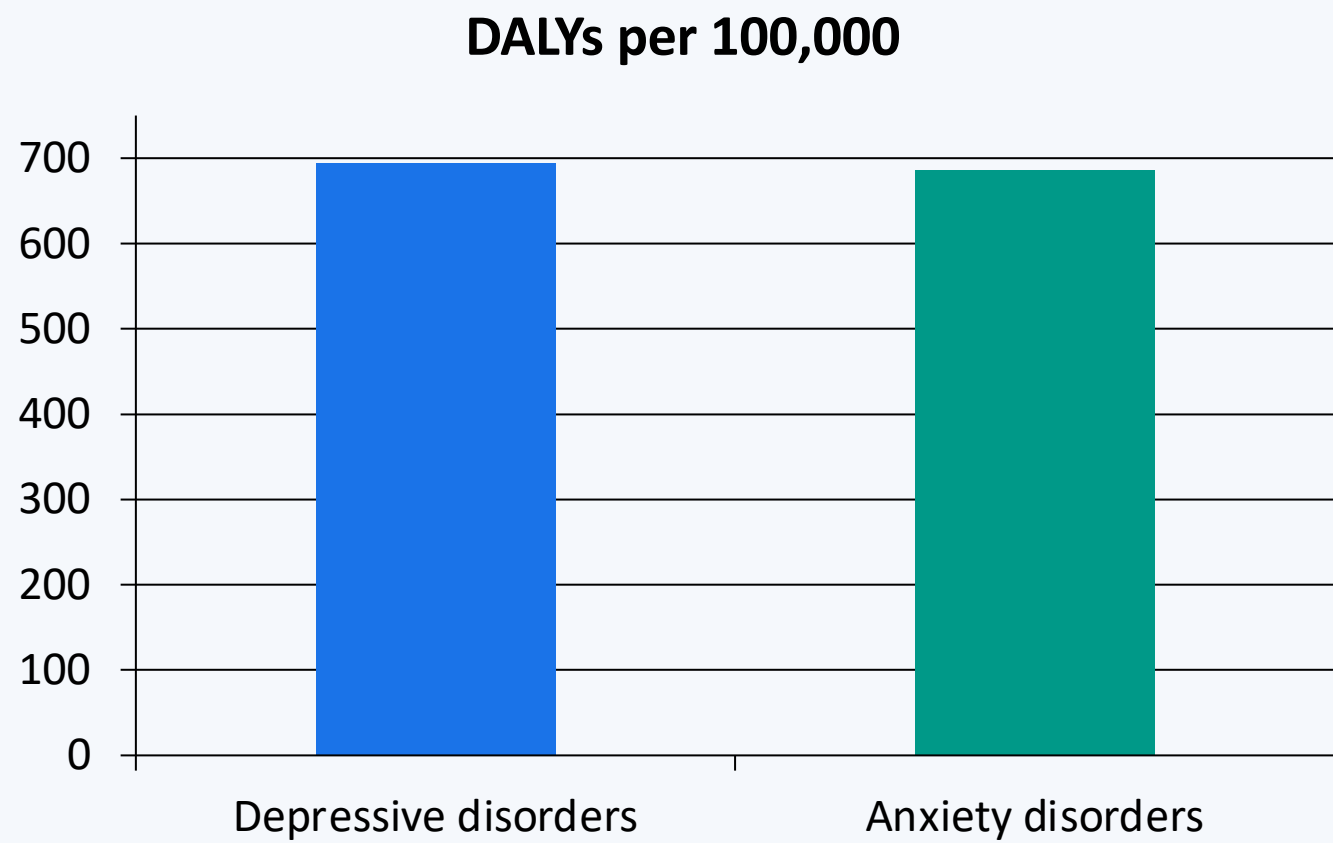
Mental health conditions range from common disorders (depressive and anxiety disorders) to less common but often severe

# Depression and Anxiety Dominate: ~695 and ~687 DALYs per 100,000



Source: OWID figure\_1 using IHME Global Burden of Disease data (DALYs per 100,000)

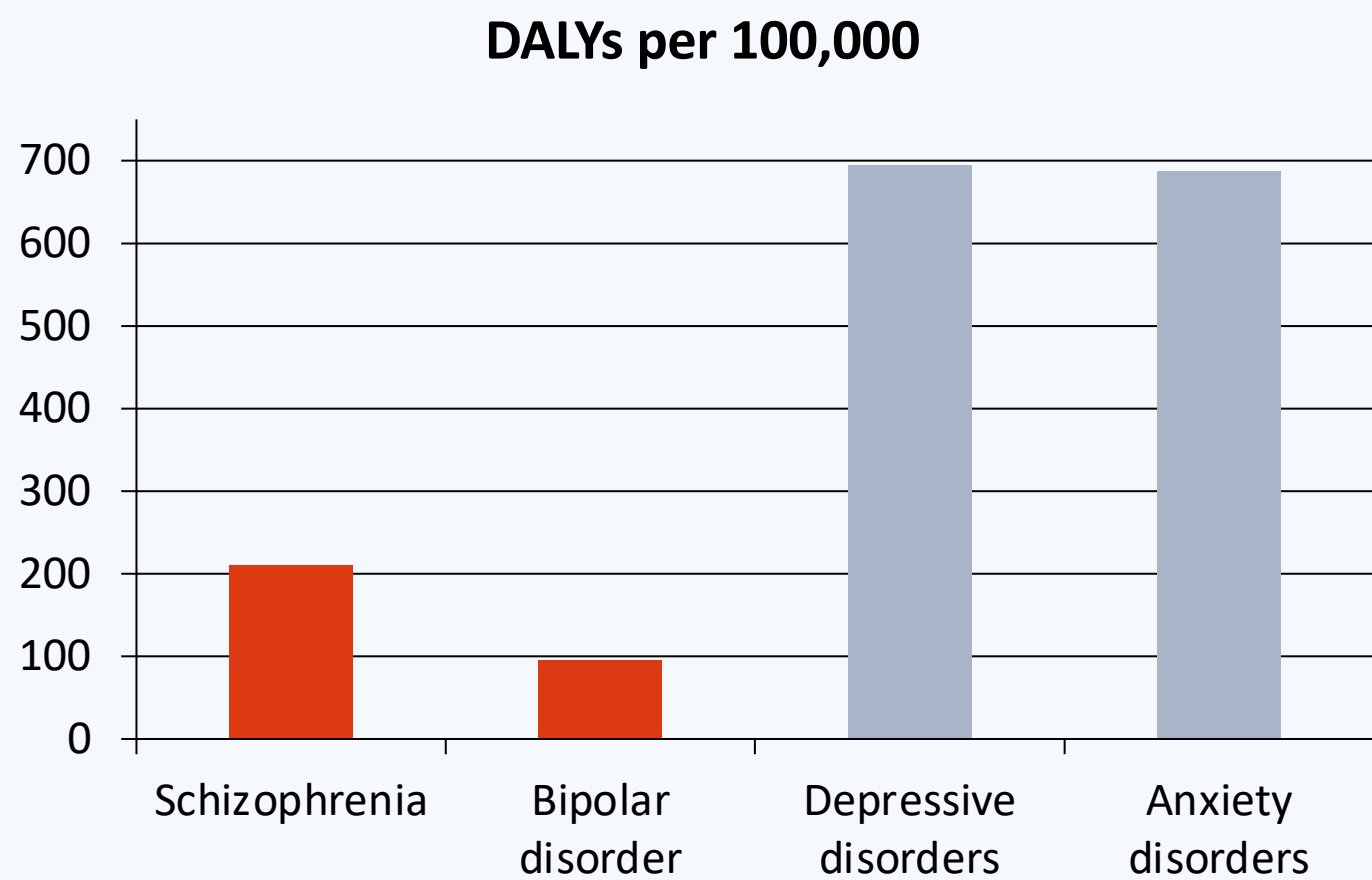
# Depression and Anxiety Carry Nearly Equal Disease Burden Worldwide



**Difference: 8.1**  
DALYs per 100,000  
Near parity indicates both disorders require comparable policy attention.

Source: Our World in Data (2023), IHME Global Burden of Disease

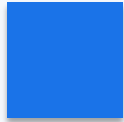
# Schizophrenia and Bipolar Disorder: Lower Prevalence but Severe



- Schizophrenia: 210.2 DALYs per 100,000
- Bipolar disorder: 94.6 DALYs per 100,000
  - Population-level burden is lower than depression/anxiety
  - but individual disability and severity are often high.

Source: Our World in Data (2023), IHME Global Burden of Disease

# Treatment Is Available but Often Lacking or Poor Quality



**Stigma:** People may avoid disclosing symptoms to professionals or people they know.



**Access:** Care remains limited in many settings, especially in low- and middle-income countries.



**Quality:** Available treatment is not always adequate or evidence-based.



**Underreporting:** Discomfort sharing symptoms can suppress measured prevalence; true burden may be higher.

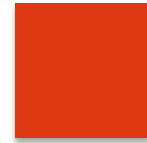
# How People Cope: From Medication to Faith to Family Conversations



**Prescribed medication**



**Religious or spiritual activities**



**Talking to friends or family**

Global survey responses show coping behaviors vary widely across countries and cultures; policy design should remain context-sensitive.

# Key Takeaways: Prioritizing Depression, Anxiety, and Closing the T

- Depression and anxiety represent the overwhelming majority of mental health DALYs globally.
- Schizophrenia and bipolar disorder have lower population DALYs but high individual severity and disability.
- Treatment exists, yet access and quality remain inadequate in many settings.
- Stigma reduces help-seeking and contributes to underreporting, limiting data accuracy.
- Policy should scale evidence-based interventions for common disorders while maintaining specialized care for severe conditions.